Year	Vote for BJP among Hindus (%)
1996	23
1998	28
1999	27
2004	25
2009	22
2014	36

Source: National Election Studies conducted by CSDS
Note: Figures weighted by actual vote share of parties in the respective years.

Modi's popularity (36 per cent) at the time of the Lok Sabha election was nearly twice that of Rahul Gandhi, Sonia Gandhi and Manmohan Singh put together (19 per cent).

Choice for PM	2014 NES Post Poll (%)
Narendra Modi	36
Rahul Gandhi	14
Sonia Gandhi	3
Mayawati	3
Mulayam Singh Yadav	2
Arvind Kejriwal	2
Manmohan Singh	2
Others	9
No opinion	29

Source: National Election Studies, 2014, conducted by Lokniti, CSDS Question asked: After this election, who would you prefer as the next Prime Minister of India? (This was an open-ended question and no names were offered to the respondents.)

Modi's popularity jumped by nearly two times between July 2013 and April–May 2014; Rahul's more or less stayed where it was.